NOVALITY CROCHET STUDIO



Axel the Axolotl

Crochet Pattern

EASY–INTERMEDIATE | US TERMS | CODE NS03

Concept image (AI-generated, not a photograph of a finished sample), shown for colour and character.
Follow the written instructions where they differ from the image.

PDF pattern — this is not a finished toy

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Axel the Axolotl

At a glance

Terminology	US Crochet Terms
Skill Level	Easy–Intermediate
Finished Size	Approx. 10.5–11.5 cm (4.25–4.5 in) seated at stated gauge — confirm on a sample
Gauge	11 sc × 11.5 rnds = 5 cm (2 in)
Hook	3.5 mm (US E-4)
Materials	**Yarn A (Pastel Pink):** Worsted (#4), ~25 g (head, body, tail, limbs) **Yarn B (Dark Pink / Magenta):** Worsted (#4), ~10 g (gill stalks and tail fin) **Eyes:** Two 9 mm black safety eyes **Notions:** Polyester fiberfill (~20 g), 10 locking stitch markers, tapestry needle, scissors

Safety — read first.

Lock safety-eye washers firmly inside before stuffing and sew all parts twice. Safety eyes are a choking hazard if detached; not for children under 3 unless the finished item meets your market's toy-safety requirements.

1. Head, Body & Tail (Yarn A — one piece, top-down)

R1: 6 sc in MR (6)

R2: inc in each st around (12)

R3: [sc, inc] × 6 (18)

R4: [2 sc, inc] × 6 (24)

R5: [3 sc, inc] × 6 (30)

R6: [4 sc, inc] × 6 (36)

R7–R12 (6 rnds): sc in each st around (36)

Insert 9 mm safety eyes between **R9 and R10**, 7 stitches apart. Embroider a wide smile between and slightly below the eyes.

R13: [4 sc, dec] × 6 (30)

R14: [3 sc, dec] × 6 (24)

R15 (Neck): [4 sc, dec] × 4 (20) (stuff head firmly)

R16: sc in each st around (20)

R17: [4 sc, inc] × 4 (24)

R18: [3 sc, inc] × 6 (30)

R19–R24 (6 rnds): sc in each st around (30)

Stuff neck and upper torso firmly.

R25: [3 sc, dec] × 6 (24)

R26: sc in each st around (24)

R27: [2 sc, dec] × 6 (18)

R28–R29 (2 rnds): sc in each st around (18)

Stuff R25–R29 **very lightly** so the tail can hinge backward. Place a locking marker in the centre-back (dorsal) stitch of **each round R29–R38** (10 markers).

R30: [sc, dec] × 6 (12)

R31–R33 (3 rnds): sc in each st around (12)

R34: [2 sc, dec] × 3 (9)

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R35–R36 (2 rnds):	sc in each st around (9)
R37:	[sc, dec] × 3 (6)
R38:	sc in each st around (6)
Vertical tail-tip closure:	Do not stuff the tip. Fold the 6-stitch opening side-to-side (3 sts against 3 sts) so the fold runs vertically (spine to belly), with the R38 dorsal marker at the top corner. Ch 1 and work **3 sc through both layers** from top (dorsal) to bottom (ventral). FO and weave in tail.

2. Gill Stalks (Yarn B — Make 6: 3 per side)

Foundation:	Ch 7.
Row 1:	Starting in 2nd ch from hook: [sc in next ch, (hdc, ch 1, hdc) in next ch] × 2, sc in last 2 ch (8)

FO with a 20 cm sewing tail. Arrange 3 stalks in a fan on each side of the head across **Head R7–R12** (about 4 stitches behind the eyes) and sew securely.

3. Limbs (Yarn A — Make 4)

R1:	6 sc in MR (6)
R2:	[sc, inc] × 3 (9)
R3–R6 (4 rnds):	sc in each st around (9)

Stuff the paw tip lightly. Flatten the opening with **one stitch at a side fold and 4 matched pairs**; work **4 sc through the four pairs**. When sewing the limb on, catch the fold stitch in the first seam stitch so no gap remains. FO with a 20 cm tail. Sew 2 arms to the sides of the body at **R17–R18** angled forward, and 2 legs to the lower front/sides at **R24–R25** so Axel sits upright.

4. Scalloped Tail Fin (Yarn B)

Hold Axel with the tail tip pointing toward you.

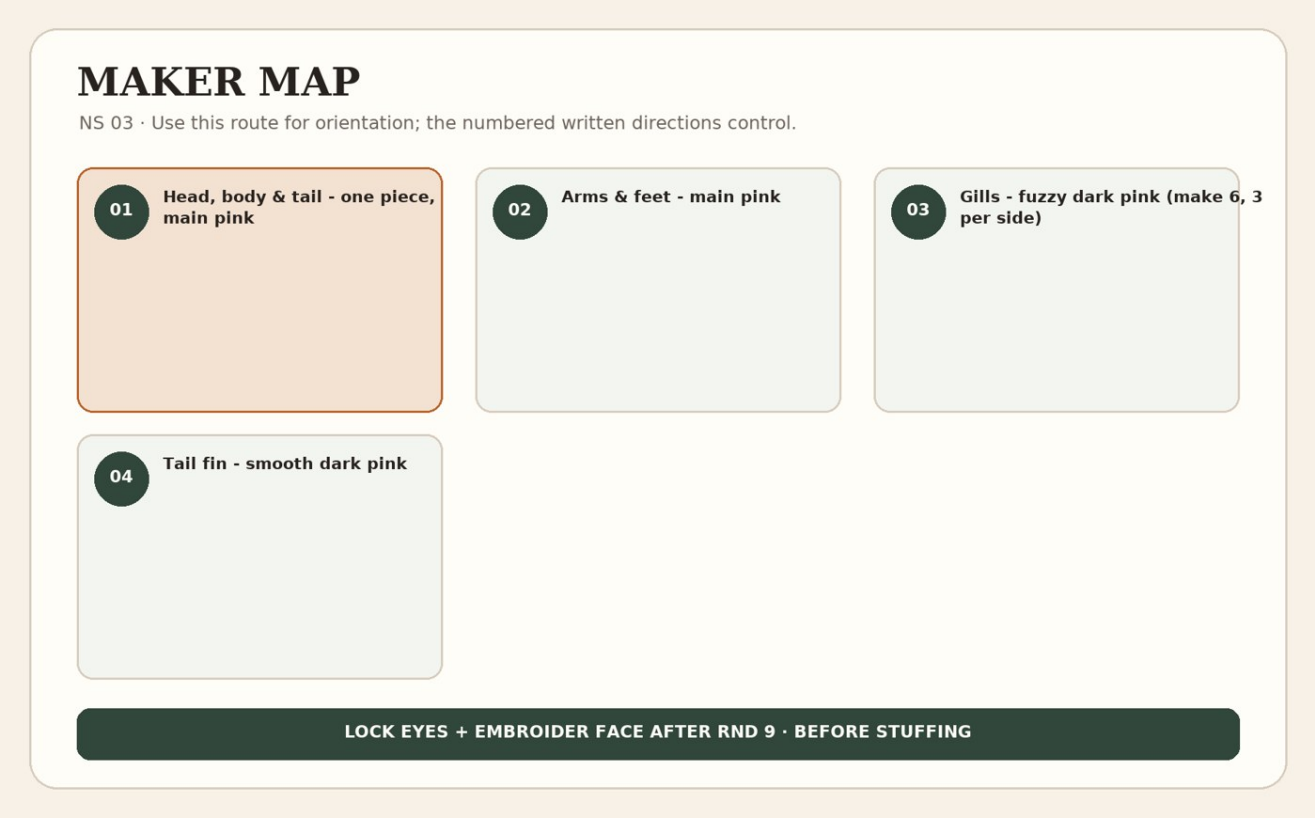
- Join Yarn B with a sl st at the **top (dorsal) corner** of the 3-sc tail-tip seam.
- Working up the centre-back along the 10 marked dorsal stitches, from R38 toward R29:

[skip 1 marker, 5 hdc into next marker's stitch, skip 1 marker, sl st into next marker's stitch] × 2, 5 hdc into the 9th marker's stitch, sl st into the 10th marker's stitch (R29) (3 shell fans; all 10 markers used).

- Continue without cutting yarn: work around the 3-sc tail-tip edge, then along the **bottom (ventral) centreline**, working **1 sc into the centre stitch of each round R38, R37, R36, R35, R34 and R33** (6 sc), ending with a sl st into the R33 centre stitch. FO and weave in ends.

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Maker map



Maker map (concept graphic, AI-generated) — use it for orientation; the written instructions in this pattern control.

Thank you for making Axel!

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